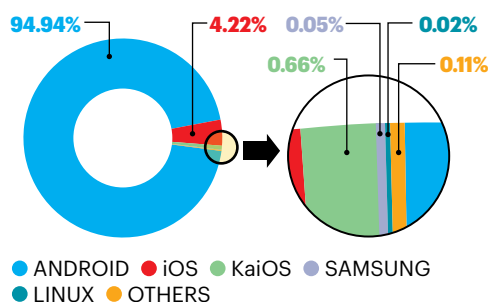


THE DUOPOLY

● Android (Google's Play Store) and iOS (Apple's App Store) are the two dominant operating systems; apps have been the driving force behind their success

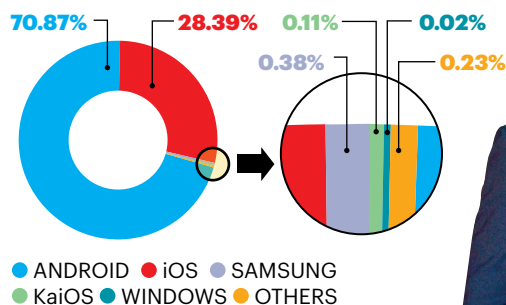
Market Share of Mobile OS in India



SUNDAR PICHAI, CEO of Alphabet and Google

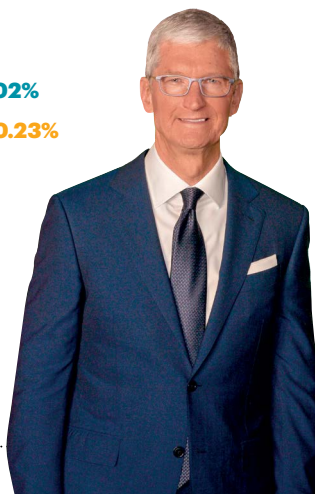


Global Market Share of Mobile OS



DATA AS OF APRIL 2024
SOURCE STATCOUNTER

TIM COOK, CEO of Apple



the high transaction fees demanded by Big Tech leading to shrinking profit margins. Mayank Kumar, Co-founder of edtech firm upGrad, says that many new companies are willing to pay a commission to get access to the market. "However, in the current ecosystem, this commission often becomes disproportionately high. The larger companies end up taking between 15-30% of the revenue, which makes it extremely challenging for younger companies to profit," he says.

According to Kumar, older firms that have achieved scale, say, 10 million users or revenues of ₹2,000-3,000 crore, can navigate the ecosystem better. "However, this creates barriers that prevent many younger companies from scaling effectively, which needs to be addressed and regulated systematically."

Indus Appstore, a made-in-India solution to this problem, is trying to bridge this gap by listing popular Indian apps. The PhonePe-owned company has a long carousel of never-ending apps ranging from popular Indian names like Blinkit, MakeMyTrip, Paytm, and JioCinema to even international brands such as Instagram, Snapchat, and WhatsApp. "The Indian tech ecosystem has grown significantly in the last decade. Indian companies are building population-scale tech products that cater to the diverse needs of the Indian market, one of the largest smartphone markets in the world," says Indus Appstore Co-founder Akash Dongre.

The growing digital infrastructure and a robust India Stack give home-grown firms a rare opportunity. "An Indian app store presents a fascinating and compelling opportunity. Such an app store could steer inclusive digital growth and offer a richer user experience, catering to India's unique voice, vernacular, and video landscape," says Prabhu Ram, Head of Industry Intelligence Group at CyberMedia Research. By catering to India, this app store can empower domestic app development and pri-

APP TIME

● The annual revenue of the app market in India has almost doubled from 2020 to 2023

